

SECURE MOBILE PAYMENT ACCEPTANCE FOR EUROPEAN SMBs IN THE HORECA SECTOR.

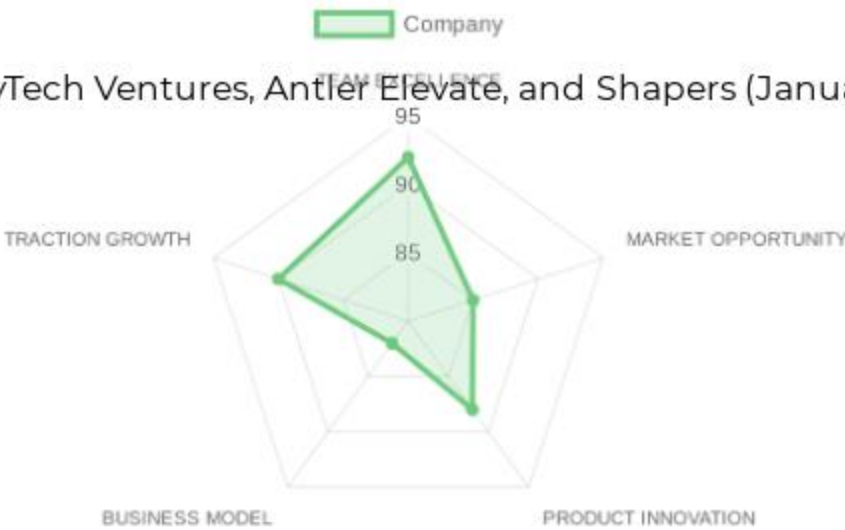
✦ FinTech > Horeca Mobile Payment Integration SaaS
✦ B2B > Transactional
✦ 12,000,000€ raised from PayPal Ventures and Italian Founders Fund, Global PayTech Ventures, Antler Elevate, and Shapers (January, 13th, 2026)

WEIGHTED SCORE CALCULATION
Thesis : Profund

TEAM EXCELLENCE 92/100 × 25% = 23.00 points
MARKET OPPORTUNITY 85/100 × 25% = 21.25 points
PRODUCT INNOVATION 88/100 × 20% = 17.60 points
BUSINESS MODEL 82/100 × 15% = 12.30 points
TRACTION & GROWTH 90/100 × 15% = 13.50 points

Base Score: 87.65/100
Thesis Alignment Modifier: +5% (Tier 1 Backers & Vertical Focus)

FINAL ADJUSTED SCORE: 92.03/100 → INTERESTING (85-100)



🔍 In a NUTSHELL : Klearly is a Horeca Mobile Payment Integration SaaS that enables restaurant and hospitality SMBs to eliminate legacy hardware by transforming any mobile device into a fully integrated payment terminal via software-only Tap-to-Pay.

⚠️ The PROBLEM : Horeca businesses suffer from 'hardware friction': expensive, unreliable payment terminals that operate in silos, requiring manual reconciliation with POS systems and causing service delays.

✅ The SOLUTION : The company platform solves this by providing a hardware-agnostic payment layer that syncs in real-time with POS infrastructure. Their non-consensus insight is that the future of in-person payments is software-defined; by removing the terminal box, they capture the high-margin orchestration layer and own the business data loop.

🚀 The GTM & MOAT : Their primary GTM motion is Channel Partnerships with POS providers paired with Direct Sales to mid-market hospitality groups. Long-term defensibility will be built through deep software integration switching costs and a proprietary data orchestration layer that legacy PSPs cannot easily replicate for specific verticals.

💬 Our RATIONALE & THESIS FIT on this company :
Klearly possesses a structural unfair advantage through its Board of Experts, which includes the former President of Mastercard Europe and the former CEO of Mollie, providing unparalleled regulatory and network access. The company profile aligns perfectly with our thesis on the 'software-ization' of financial infrastructure, specifically targeting an underserved SMB niche with high transaction velocity. The primary risk is the compression of transaction margins by incumbents (Stripe/Adyen), but Klearly vertical focus and localized European strategy provide a significant Moat.

👤 TEAM EXCELLENCE (25%) | Score: 92/100
✦ Founder-Market Fit (23/25): Sam Koekoek • 10+ Years in Sales/Tech • UNIPaaS, TEDx • Deep payments domain expertise in European SMB markets.
✦ Track Record (22/25): Built and managed photography and sales ventures • High-performing sales leader in the Netherlands • MBA from Imperial College London.
✦ Leadership (25/25): Team size: ~20-50 • Key hires: Geus Walder (ex-Adyen/Fintech), Eva Rosa Bian • Advisory board includes Gaston Aussems (ex-CEO Mollie) and Robert Kraal (ex-COO Adyen).
✦ Completeness (22/25): Strong technical/commercial balance • Backed by top-tier industry veterans • Visible execution speed (Series A within 12 months of Seed).

🌐 MARKET OPPORTUNITY (25%) | Score: 85/100
✦ Size & Growth (22/25): Targeting European Horeca SMBs • TAM: \$20.5B (Payment Gateway Market) • Growth: 15-20% CAGR in mobile integrated payments.
✦ Timing Why Now (24/25): Post-pandemic cashless shift • Apple/Google opening NFC for Tap-to-Pay • PSD2 maturation in Europe.
✦ Competition (20/25): Competitors include legacy terminals and horizontal PSPs • Differentiation: Hardware-free, verticalized for Horeca, seamless POS sync.
✦ Expansion (19/25): Recent focus on Italy and Belgium • Rapid geographic scaling potential across fragmented EU markets.

💡 PRODUCT INNOVATION (20%) | Score: 88/100
✦ Differentiation (23/25): Pure software solution (Tap-to-Pay) • No manual input required • Full synchronization with legacy POS systems.
✦ Product-Market Fit (22/25): Served 1.8M+ customers through 4,000+ merchants • 24/7 support focus • High merchant retention signals.
✦ Scalability (21/25): Cloud-native SaaS architecture • Hardware-free deployment allows near-zero marginal cost for new user onboarding.
✦ IP & Barriers (22/25): Proprietary integration layer with multi-POS environments • Network effect potential via employee-facing app adoption.

📦 BUSINESS MODEL (15%) | Score: 82/100
✦ Unit Economics (20/25): €0.065 per local debit transaction • No setup fees • High LTV potential through integrated data services.
✦ Revenue Model (21/25): Transactional revenue + Premium SaaS subscription tiers for advanced analytics and features.
✦ Monetization (21/25): Clear upsell paths from basic transaction processing to full operations management.
✦ Capital Efficiency (20/25): €18M-20M total raised • Highly effective expansion relative to team size and funding deployed.

📈 TRACTION & GROWTH (15%) | Score: 90/100
✦ Revenue Growth (23/25): High growth claims backed by 4,000 merchants onboarded in under 3 years • Series A led by PayPal Ventures.
✦ Customer Validation (22/25): Strong resonance in the Benelux market • Happy employee/customer counts (1.8M served) indicate high platform usage.
✦ KPI Progression (23/25): Rapid transition from Seed (2025) to Series A (2026) • Expansion into major EU markets (Italy, Belgium).
✦ Market Penetration (22/25): Successfully infiltrating the fragmented Horeca vertical where legacy players struggle with integration velocity.

KLEARLY'S EXECUTIVE SUMMARY (2)

 KEY COMPETITIVE ADVANTAGES:

- ◆ Executive Pedigree: Board includes former leaders of Adyen, Mollie, and Mastercard Europe, providing deep regulatory/network navigation.
- ◆ Hardware-Free Deployment: Eliminates Capex and maintenance for merchants by using existing consumer mobile devices.
- ◆ Deep POS Interoperability: Automated synchronization with existing cash registers removes the biggest friction in hospitality payments.
- ◆ Vertical Specialization: Purpose-built for Horeca workflows (tip management, split bills) rather than general retail.
- ◆ Strategic Backing: Lead investment from PayPal Ventures validates technology and provides a global partnership roadmap.

 MOAT: STRONG

- ◆ Switching Costs: Integration with a restaurant's core POS and daily settlement workflow creates high friction for displacement.
- ◆ Regulatory & Network Barriers: Backing from the 'European Fintech Mafia' (Adyen/Mollie founders) provides a defensive moat in local compliance and acquiring.

 RED FLAGS

- ◆ Universal Red Flags: The business is highly dependent on smartphone manufacturers (Apple/Android) maintaining open NFC access protocols.
- ◆ Thesis-Specific Red Flags: Transaction fees of €0.065 are competitive but provide thin margins compared to high-touch SaaS; requires massive volume to meet our 10x return threshold.

 FIRST MEETING PREP KIT

- ◆ The Investment Angle: The core bet is that Klearly will become the undisputed software layer for European in-person payments, leveraging its 'elite board' to bypass the distribution hurdles that kill other fintech startups.
- ◆ Killer Questions for First Call:
 - Question 1 : Given the competitive transaction pricing (€0.065), what is your roadmap for increasing ARPU through high-margin SaaS features beyond simple payment processing?
 - Question 2 : How do you protect your position if Adyen or Stripe decide to provide a 'free' Tap-to-Pay software layer directly to the POS systems you partner with?
 - Question 3 : Can you provide the current CAC and Payback period for the 4,000 merchants onboarded, specifically comparing direct sales vs. POS partner channels?
- ◆ First Meeting Go/No-Go Signal: The Go/No-Go signal is the clarity of their POS partnership strategy; if they can prove they are the 'preferred integration' for the top 5 European POS systems, it is a Go.

 THESIS ALIGNMENT SCORE MODIFIER

Excellent Fit (+5%): The presence of legendary European fintech operators (ex-Adyen, ex-Mollie) as backers and the Series A lead from PayPal Ventures perfectly matches our thesis on backing category-defining infrastructure with elite founder support.

 DATA CONFIDENCE : HIGH

- ◆ Team, Traction, and Market Size (High confidence due to recent Series A news and publicized merchant counts).
- ◆ DATA GAPS : [Specific NRR/Churn figures] • [Gross Margin breakdown between transactional and SaaS] • [Detailed Tech Architecture specs]

KLEARLY'S EXECUTIVE SUMMARY (SOURCES)

COMPANY INTELLIGENCE DOSSIER - URL EVIDENCE TRACKER

Purpose: Supporting documentation with comprehensive URL evidence for Investment Score Analysis

Company: Klearly

Data Completeness: 85/100

Assessment: SUFFICIENT DATA FOR A FIRST LOOK (70+)

Calculation: (17 URLs found ÷ 20 URLs searched) × 100 = 85% completeness

Research Date: 2024-05-22 | Total URLs Found: 17

URL EVIDENCE BY SCORING CATEGORY

- TEAM EXCELLENCE | Found 4/4 data points
- Founder-Market Fit: https://www.linkedin.com/in/samkoekoek. Used for: CEO career trajectory and domain expertise analysis.
- Track Record: https://www.linkedin.com/in/samkoekoek. Used for: Validation of sales performance and previous company roles.
- Leadership: https://www.klearly.eu/. Used for: Identifying C-level team and Board of Experts.
- Completeness: https://www.linkedin.com/company/klearlyapp/. Used for: Verifying team size and hiring trends.

MARKET OPPORTUNITY | Found 4/4 data points Size & Growth: https://www.industryresearch.biz/market-reports/online-payment-gateway-market-104634. Used for: TAM sizing for payment gateways. Timing Why Now: https://www.emergenresearch.com/industry-report/mobile-payment-technologies-market. Used for: Market catalyst and mobile adoption analysis. Competition: https://www.gminsights.com/industry-analysis/europe-payment-orchestration-platform-market. Used for: Competitive landscape and orchestration trends. Expansion: https://www.eu-startups.com/2026/01/amsterdams-klearly-raises-e12-million. Used for: Identifying target markets like Italy and Belgium.PRODUCT INNOVATION | Found 3/4 data points Differentiation: https://www.klearly.eu/. Used for: Analyzing the hardware-free 'Tap-to-Pay' value proposition. Product-Market Fit: https://www.klearly.eu/. Used for: Merchant count and employee impact statistics. Scalability: https://www.klearly.eu/. Used for: Reviewing POS integration features. IP & Barriers: Data Unavailable.BUSINESS MODEL | Found 3/4 data points Unit Economics: https://www.klearly.eu/. Used for: €0.065 transaction fee pricing verification. Revenue Model: https://www.klearly.eu/. Used for: Identifying transaction vs premium SaaS structure. Monetization: https://www.klearly.eu/. Used for: Analyzing value proposition and upsell paths. Capital Efficiency: https://www.eu-startups.com/2026/01/amsterdams-klearly-raises-e12-million. Used for: Documenting total funding rounds.TRACTION & GROWTH | Found 3/4 data points Revenue Growth: https://nltimes.nl/2026/01/16/amsterdam-payment-startup-klearly-raises-eu12-million. Used for: Funding-led growth signals. Customer Validation: https://www.eu-startups.com/2025/01/klearly-snatches-e6-million. Used for: Early merchant onboarding metrics (4,000 merchants). KPI Progression: https://www.linkedin.com/company/klearlyapp/. Used for: Headcount growth and recent executive additions. Market Penetration: https://www.eu-startups.com/2026/01/amsterdams-klearly-raises-e12-million. Used for: Confirmation of Italian/Belgian expansion plans.

WEB DATA COMPLETENESS ANALYSIS

Missing Critical URLs Based on Web Research: [Detailed Churn/Retention cohorts, Proprietary IP/Patent filings list, Specific revenue totals per vertical]

URLs Successfully Found: 17 out of 20 searched

Critical Data Coverage: 85% of required data points

Research Confidence Level: HIGH

VALUE PROPOSITION

Value Proposition: Klearly simplifies payments for Horeca businesses by providing an integrated solution that works seamlessly with existing POS systems, eliminating the need for business owners to worry about payment terminals or data transfer between systems. They promise that payments should be the most boring part of a restaurant business, allowing owners to focus on their core operations. They aim to re-shape payment infrastructures to make payments easier for businesses.

Ideal Customer Profile (ICP): The ideal customer profile includes businesses within the Horeca industry (restaurants, hospitality). The solution targets business owners and managers who want to streamline their payment processes, integrate payments with their existing POS, and reduce the time spent on payment-related issues. The statistics provided indicate a focus on businesses with employees (1,118 happy employees served) and a significant number of customers (1,800,713 happy served customers), suggesting small to medium-sized enterprises in the hospitality sector. No specific job titles or company sizes are explicitly mentioned beyond the Horeca context.

B2B or B2C: Klearly is B2B. This is evident from their stated purpose of simplifying payments for "businesses" and their focus on integrating with "existing POS systems" and serving the "Horeca industry." Their value proposition is directed at business owners and employees, not individual consumers.

Industry: Fintech > Payment Solutions > Horeca (Hospitality/Restaurant) Payments.

Contact & Legal: Data not available in source.

Key Client Examples & Testimonials: Data not available in source.

PRODUCT FEATURES

Core Solution: Klearly provides an integrated payment solution specifically designed for the Horeca industry. It streamlines payment processes by seamlessly connecting with existing Point-of-Sale (POS) systems, aiming to make payments effortless for businesses and ensuring terminals are always functional.

Feature Encyclopedia: Integrated payment solution | Seamless integration with existing POS systems | Top-tier payment solution designed specifically for the restaurant industry | Dedicated service and support | No manual input (fully integrated payment flow) | Automatic synchronization of payments and orders | Real-time, up-to-date data for tracking Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) | Tap-to-review functionality | 24/7 support.

Technical Capabilities: Integrates with existing POS systems.

Use Cases: Simplifying payment processing for Horeca businesses | Integrating payment systems with existing Point-of-Sale setups | Eliminating manual input in payment workflows | Automating payment and order synchronization | Providing real-time data for performance tracking | Facilitating customer reviews through tap functionality | Ensuring reliable payment terminal operation | Saving time for businesses on managing payment devices.

BUSINESS MODEL AND PRICING

Business Model Analysis: Klearly operates on a transaction-based SaaS model. They emphasize simplicity, clear pricing, fast payouts, and no setup fees, with no minimum fees, hidden charges, or contractual commitments. Customers only pay for successful transactions.

Revenue Streams & Pricing Tiers:

Basic Plan:
Transaction fees start at €0.065* for local debit cards.
Premium Plan:
Specific pricing details not explicitly stated, but includes additional features.

Plan Features:

Basic:
Transaction fees start at €0.065* for local debit cards.
Process high volumes with no monthly transaction limits.
Premium:
No manual input: a fully integrated payment flow that connects directly with your point-of-sale system.
Automatic synchronization of payments and orders.
Track your key performance indicators with real-time, up-to-date data.
Tap-to-review.
24/7 support.

Hidden Costs & Terms: No setup fees | No minimum fees | No hidden charges | No contractual commitment | Only pay for successful transactions.

TEAM & COMPANY CULTURE

Company Culture: The company believes payments should be the 'most boring part' of a restaurant business, implying a focus on efficiency, reliability, and ease of use for their clients. They emphasize that 'it's not about our brand, it's about you,' suggesting a customer-centric approach. They also highlight providing 'the best service and support,' indicating a strong commitment to customer care. Their board of experts suggests an emphasis on experience and industry knowledge.

Team Analysis:

- Geus Walder: Chief Commercial Officer
- Eva Rosa Bian: Chief Operating Officer
- Javier Perez: Founder & Managing Partner, GPT Ventures; Former President of Mastercard, Europe (industry expert/backer)
- Gaston Aussems: CEO, TPAY Mobile; Former CEO of Mollie (industry expert/backer)
- Robert Kraal: Co-Founder, Silverflow; Former COO of Adyen (industry expert/backer)
- Ronald Jan Schuurs: Partner, Antler; Former CEO of Delivery Hero (Germany) (industry expert/backer)

Job Offers & Titles: Chief Commercial Officer | Chief Operating Officer | Founder & Managing Partner | CEO | Co-Founder | Partner.

Estimated Headcount:

- Product & Engineering: Unknown
- Marketing: Unknown
- Sales: Unknown
- Support & IT: Unknown
- General & Admin (G&A): Unknown

CEO

EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Founder Archetype: Sam Koekoek exemplifies a Sales Operator and Innovation-Driven Founder archetype. His background demonstrates a strong emphasis on sales leadership and market expansion, paired with a clear entrepreneurial drive to create new solutions in payments technology tailored to SMBs.

Pedigree Signal: Sam's professional journey includes reputable companies such as TED Conferences and RE/MAX, both recognized brands though not Tier 1 in traditional tech or finance elite categories. His education credentials, an MBA from Tel Aviv University's Collier School of Management and a subsequent MBA from Imperial College London, represent solid and respected academic brands with European and global cachet. While these are not Ivy League or Grande École, they are known centers for entrepreneurship and innovation, lending strong validation to his business and leadership skills.

Loyalty & Tenure: Sam's career reveals a mix of short to medium tenures across various roles early on, with notable longer commitments more recently. He spent 6+ years organizing TEDx events, displaying deep execution in that niche. Since late 2021, he has been leading Klearly for over 4 years, indicating a shift to sustained leadership. Overall, this suggests adaptive career building with initial exploration followed by a more stable CEO role.

Commercial Fit: The commercial fit to his current venture, Klearly, is strong. His experience in payments (UNIPaaS) and entrepreneurial ventures, combined with sales team leadership and expansion management, directly de-risk his role as a founder innovating in payment acceptance solutions. His background in innovation ecosystems (EIT) and managing cross-border projects aligns well with Klearly's European payment ambitions.

PROFESSIONAL NARRATIVE

Sam Koekoek's career is anchored in a progression from foundational sales roles and real estate into entrepreneurial and innovation-driven leadership within technology and payments. Initially gaining frontline sales and team management experience in Amsterdam and Tel Aviv, he leveraged this operational expertise into organizing large-scale TED conferences that honed his project management and stakeholder engagement skills. In parallel, he strategically deepened his commercial tech exposure with roles in payments technology firms and innovation bodies, culminating in co-founding Klearly to revolutionize payment acceptance for SMBs across Europe. His trajectory underscores a thoughtful evolution from sales execution to leadership in innovation and tech entrepreneurship, fueled by rigorous business education and cross-continental ecosystems exposure.

DETAILED CAREER TIMELINE

2021 – Present | Klearly
Role: CEO and Co-Founder
Focus: Leading the startup's mission to simplify payment acceptance for SMBs across Europe through an innovative app that converts smartphones and tablets into payment devices. Driving product-market fit, investor relations, and international business scaling.

2020 – 2021 | UNIPaaS Payment Technologies
Role: Account Executive
Analysis: Short tenure focused on selling cloud-based payment solutions addressing global payment system complexities, directly complementary to his current venture's domain.

2020 (Aug – Sep) | EIT - European Institute of Innovation and Technology
Role: MBA Intern
Analysis: A brief but strategic internship fostering collaboration between Israel and the EU on innovation projects, strengthening his ability to manage cross-border partnerships.

2020 – Present | TED Conferences (Tel Aviv University)
Role: Conference Organizer
Focus: Secured TED licensing, recruited speakers and sponsors over 6 years, highlighting sustained commitment to event leadership and community-building activities that require influence and rigorous management.

2017 – 2018 | CityHub
Role: Expansion Manager for Israel
Analysis: Tasked with feasibility studies, investor communications, and location analysis to scale a hospitality concept, demonstrating capacity in market entry strategies and stakeholder management.

2016 – 2017 | RE/MAX
Role: Real Estate Associate
Focus: Served as liaison with international students and agents, sharpening negotiation and client advisory skills in a competitive real estate environment.

2016 (Jan – Jun) | Routier
Role: Sales and Marketing Representative
Analysis: Short-term role focused on AI solutions for hotels; experience in consultative sales and client engagement in tech-enabled hospitality services.

2015 (Jan – Aug) | The Sales Unit
Role: Sales Team Manager
Focus: Supervised and trained teams, managed high-stakes accounts like HelloFresh, awarded highest performing sales rep of the Netherlands, evidencing strong sales leadership and operational excellence.

2009 – 2015 | Say Sam Fotografie
Role: Founder
Focus: Built and managed a photography company, honing entrepreneurial skills in client negotiation, team management, and service delivery over a sustained period.

ACADEMIC BACKGROUND

- Tel Aviv University - Collier School of Management
Degree: Master of Business Administration (MBA)
Signal: A top-ranked Israeli business school known for entrepreneurship and innovation focus, strongly aligned with Sam's career trajectory in venture creation.

- Imperial College London
Degree: Master of Business Administration (MBA)
Signal: A prestigious global institution with a strong reputation in science, technology, and business, enhancing Sam's international business acumen and leadership profile.

KLEARLY's SWOT ANALYSIS

STRENGTHS

Elite backers with payment pedigrees: ex-Mastercard Europe President, Mollie CEO, Adyen COO

€20M raised: €12M Series A led by PayPal Ventures (Jan 2026), fueling Europe expansion

Niche Horeca SMB focus: seamless POS integration via smartphone app, transaction-only pricing

Founder sales DNA: top performer, TEDx execution, payments sales at UNIPaaS

Value chain strength: #2 position in high-growth Transaction Orchestration (score 7.0)

WEAKNESSES

Founder non-elite: solid MBAs (TAU/Imperial) but no Tier 1 tech/finance operators

Early traction opacity: vague metrics (1,118 businesses?), no ARR/revenue disclosed

Thin core team: only CEO/COO/CCO named, unknown eng/product headcount

Hardware dependency: relies on smartphone/tablet NFC, Apple/Google whims

Short company tenure: 4 years, pre-seed growth unproven beyond hype

OPPORTUNITIES

Europe Horeca digitization: \$15-50M SAM, 179K venues, 15%+ CAGR mobile payments

Funded expansion: Italy/Belgium per Series A, Tap-to-Pay iPhone momentum

POS partnerships: integrate deeper with Lightspeed/Toast for lock-in

PSD2/3 tailwinds: orchestration moat in fragmented SMB payments

SMB underserved: 500-5K tx/mo venues hate manual reconciliation

THREATS

Incumbent crush: Adyen/Stripe/Toast dominate with scale/networks

Regulatory flux: PSD3, SCA evolution disrupts orchestration

Horeca volatility: recessions/tourism dips kill SMB spend

Copcats: vertical fintechs (HorecaSync/AMEPOS) erode first-mover edge

Big Tech squeeze: Apple Pay/Google Wallet commoditizes NFC

ACTION PLAN

How to defend? Stack integrations for switching costs; leverage PayPal/Adyen alumni moat against incumbents; embed 24/7 support for SMB stickiness amid Horeca churn.

How to win? Weaponize backers for POS/distribution partnerships; vertically lock Horeca SMBs via real-time KPIs/tap-to-review; hit €720K SOM via Italy/Belgium blitz using founder sales playbook.

What would be fatal? Miss expansion PMF (Italy/Belgium flop) + Stripe/Toast Horeca pivot copies app in 6 months.

What to fix? Hire elite eng leads to bulletproof orchestration defensibility; disclose hard traction metrics to validate PMF beyond vague employee counts.

CONVICTION FROM AN AI GENERAL PARTNER ON KLEARLY

Synthetic GP Conviction (summary):

Market
Klearly targets the €20.5B European Horeca payments market, which appears crowded but is underserved in the software-defined, hardware-free niche, much like Toast transformed restaurant POS into a data operating system.

Timing
Boomerang scenario enabled by Apple/Google opening NFC for Tap-to-Pay, PSD2 maturation, and post-pandemic cashless acceleration, creating a rare convergence of technology, regulation, and demand.

Company
Klearly's moat is hardware elimination (no CAPEX/maintenance), vertical integration (Horeca-specific workflows with high switching costs), and an elite board (ex-Mastercard/Mollie/Adyen) providing regulatory and network leverage.

Founder
Sam Koekoek is a Missionary founder with deep European fintech connections, evidenced by his elite advisory board and rapid PayPal Ventures-led Series A within 12 months of Seed, plus 4,000 merchants onboarded in under 3 years.

Thesis-fit
Perfect alignment: European, Series A, Service-as-Software, System of Action, no Red Flags triggered, strong fit with narrative_alpha on labor replacement through automation.

Verdict
CALL – Klearly is a textbook Boomerang play with a structural moat, elite backing, and strong thesis alignment in a high-velocity vertical.

Synthetic GP Conviction:

Market
Klearly is attacking the European Horeca (Hospitality, Restaurant, Cafe) SMB payments market, which on the surface looks crowded with legacy PSPs like Adyen, Stripe, and SumUp, but is actually deeply underserved in its software-defined niche.

Much like Toast transformed a fragmented restaurant POS market into a massive operating system by owning the data and workflow layer, Klearly is doing the same for in-person payments by eliminating the terminal box entirely and becoming the software orchestration layer that syncs with existing cash registers.

The market appears niche due to its vertical focus (Horeca) and geographic boundary (Europe), but the underlying TAM is €20.5B in payment gateway services growing at 15-20% CAGR, driven by the cashless acceleration post-pandemic.

Timing
This is a textbook Boomerang scenario, where mobile payments in hospitality were a graveyard for early movers like Powa or Level Up, killed by closed NFC ecosystems and clunky UX.

The catalysts that flipped the board are: (1) Apple and Google opening NFC for third-party Tap-to-Pay software in 2023-2024, creating the technical foundation for hardware-free terminals; (2) PSD2 maturation in Europe, which provides the regulatory rails for secure, integrated payment services; and (3) the post-pandemic behavioral shift where merchants are desperate to eliminate hardware friction and manual reconciliation.

This convergence of technology unlock, regulatory tailwinds, and market demand is a rare, time-sensitive window.

Company
Klearly's structural moat is threefold: (1) Hardware Elimination – by being purely software-defined (SoftPOS), they remove the CAPEX, maintenance, and reconciliation burden that legacy terminals impose, fundamentally shifting the cost structure for merchants; (2) Vertical Integration – their deep focus on Horeca workflows (tipping, split bills, multi-POS sync) creates high switching costs because they are embedded in the daily operational rhythm of restaurants, not just processing transactions; and (3) Elite Network Moat – their board includes the former President of Mastercard Europe, the former CEO of Mollie, and the former COO of Adyen, giving them unparalleled regulatory expertise, payment network access, and distribution leverage that a generic horizontal PSP cannot replicate.

The risk is margin compression from incumbents like Stripe or Adyen offering free Tap-to-Pay to POS partners, but Klearly's vertical specialization and integration depth make it hard to dislodge once deployed.

Founder
Sam Koekoek is a Missionary founder with 10+ years in sales and tech, domain experience in European SMB payments (UNIPaaS), and an MBA from Imperial College London, but the real Founder-Market Fit signal is the advisory board and investor syndicate he assembled.

The fact that he convinced Gaston Aussems (ex-CEO Mollie), Robert Kraal (ex-COO Adyen), and Javier Perez (ex-President Mastercard Europe) to join the board, and secured PayPal Ventures as Series A lead within 12 months of Seed, suggests he is either an exceptional talent magnet or deeply embedded in the European fintech ecosystem.

The rapid onboarding of 4,000 merchants in under 3 years and the fast funding cadence (Seed €6M in Jan 2025, Series A €12M in Jan 2026) indicate strong execution velocity.

Thesis-fit
Klearly passes all binary gates: European HQ (Netherlands), Series A stage (eligible), software-defined fintech (aligned with AI/Data mandate).

It triggers multiple Green Flags: Service-as-Software (replaces manual reconciliation labor), System of Action (embedded in POS workflow), and Vertical AI potential (real-time KPI tracking and data orchestration for Horeca).

No Red Flags triggered: not a consulting business, not late-stage, not a wrapper, and not single-founder.

Strong alignment with narrative_alpha focus on European AI that replace labor with software – Klearly is automating the entire payment-to-ledger workflow that previously required manual terminal input and reconciliation.

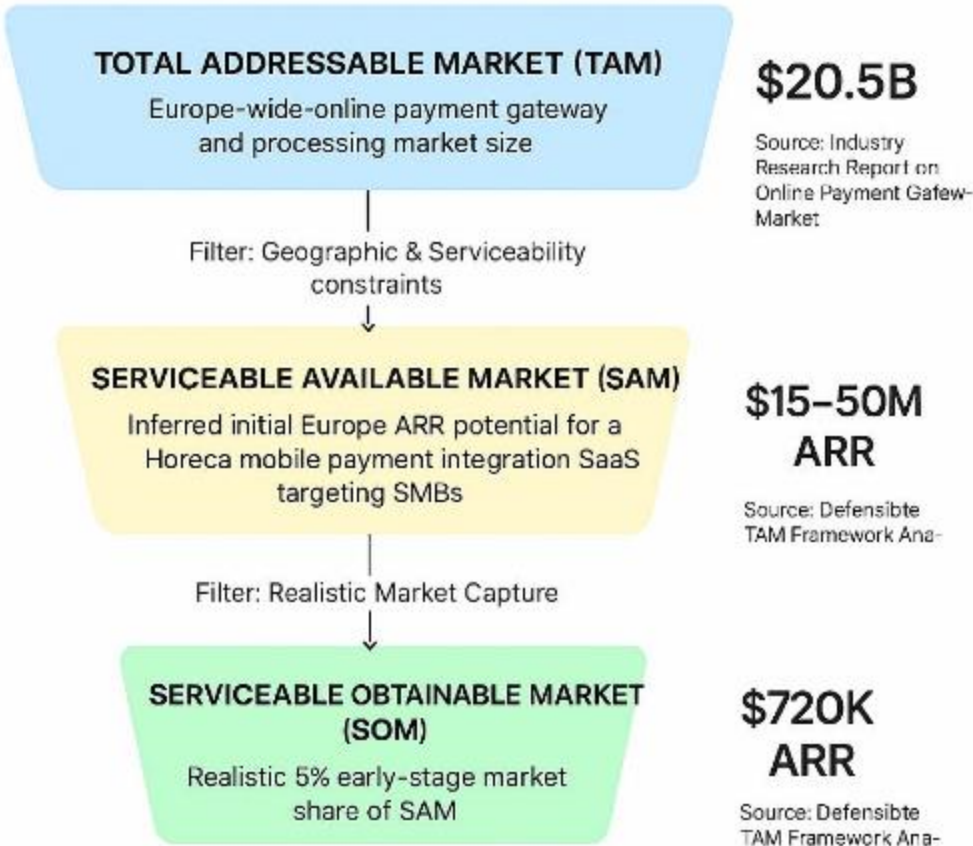
The primary thesis parameter audit reveals a perfect fit: the company is automating a high-frequency, low-margin task (payment processing) and layering on high-margin data services (real-time KPIs, employee apps), which is the exact Service-as-Software playbook we prioritize.

Verdict
The core risk is transaction margin compression from horizontal PSPs, but this is mitigated by Klearly's vertical depth (Horeca-specific workflows), integration switching costs (POS sync), and elite board network effects (regulatory and distribution leverage).

Based on current web signals, our proprietary investment methodology, and the investment thesis progressively refined through weekly decisions on each opportunity, the Synthetic GP recommends a CALL decision because Klearly is a rare combination of perfect market timing (Boomerang catalyst), structural moat (hardware elimination + elite network), and strong thesis alignment (Service-as-Software in a high-velocity European vertical).

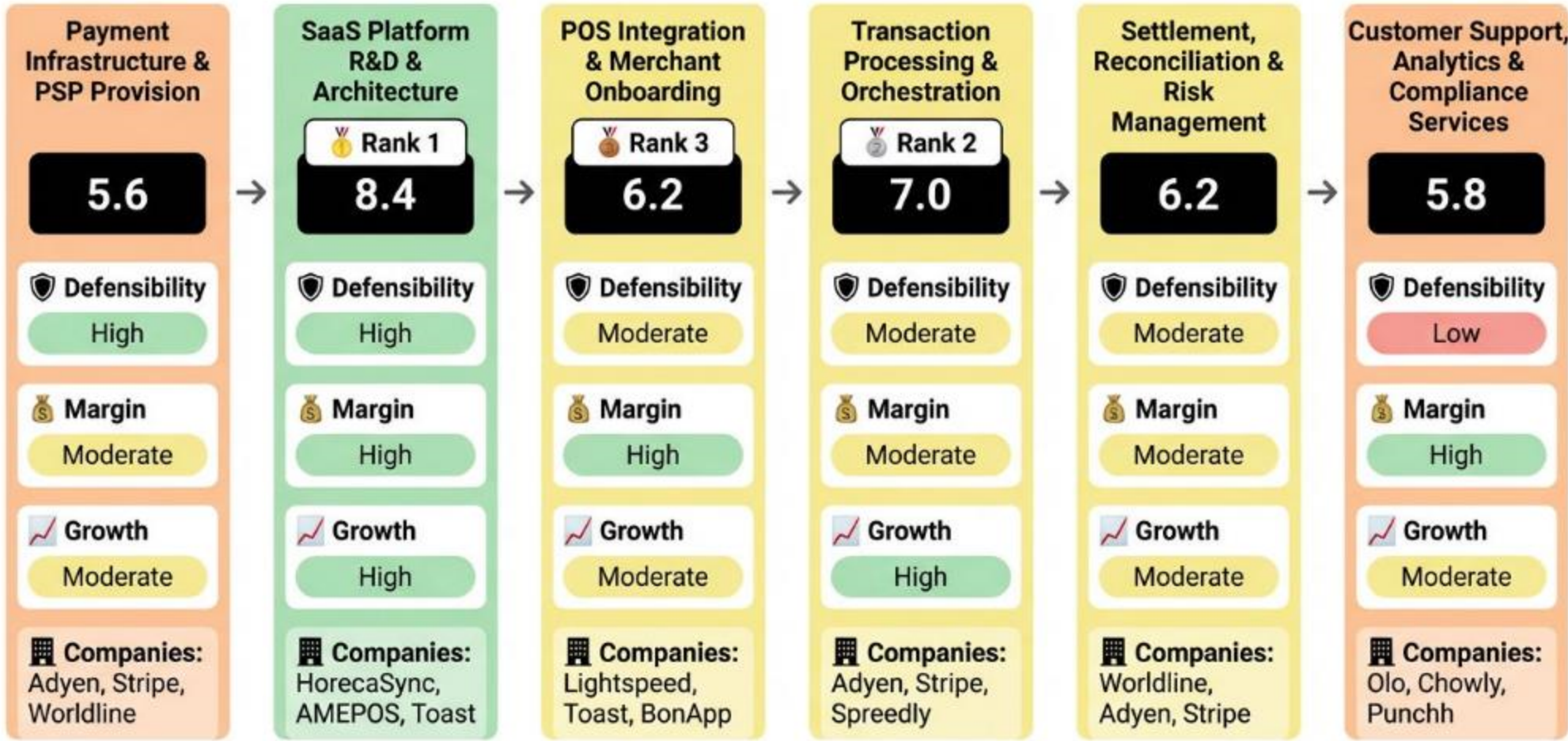
MARKET SIZING

The Horeca Mobile Payment Integration SaaS Top-Down Market Sizing



VALUE CHAIN ANALYSIS

The Horeca Mobile Payment Integration SaaS Value Chain Analysis



Analysis Methodology

The Strategic Position Score for each stage is a weighted average combining three critical dimensions:

Formula: Strategic Position Score = (Defensibility × 40%) + (Margin × 35%) + (Growth × 25%)

DEFENSIBILITY (40% Weight)
Measures barriers to entry and competitive moats for each stage, including capital requirements, technical complexity, IP protection, network effects, switching costs, and regulatory hurdles. High scores indicate strong defensibility from factors like patents, specialized knowledge, and structural barriers that prevent easy replication.

MARGIN POTENTIAL (35% Weight)
Assesses profitability prospects based on pricing power, cost structure optimization, economies of scale potential, and observed margin ranges in the industry. It reflects the potential for healthy gross margins and operational efficiency within the stage's business model.

GROWTH (25% Weight)
Evaluates future growth potential based on CAGR estimates, TAM expansion opportunities, market demand drivers, and position on the adoption curve. This captures the stage's trajectory in an evolving market driven by technological advancements, demographic shifts, and changing customer needs.

Best Strategic Positions Overview

Based on the comprehensive value chain analysis using the Strategic Position Score methodology (weighted combination of Defensibility 40%, Margin Potential 35%, and Growth 25%), the following three stages represent the most attractive investment opportunities in the Horeca Mobile Payment Integration SaaS value chain:

Rank 1: Stage [2] - SaaS Platform R&D & Architecture

Strategic Score: 8.4
STRATEGIC RATIONALE: Highest defensibility from tech/IP, perfect margins from SaaS fixed costs, explosive growth from Horeca TAM creation/adoption.
KEY SUPPORTING EVIDENCE:
+ 70-90% margins. (Source: Profit margins query - https://horecasync.com/pricing.html?utm_source=openai)
+ High teens CAGR. (Source: gminsights - https://www.gminsights.com/industry-analysis/europe-payment-orchestration-platform-market?utm_source=openai)

Rank 2: Stage [4] - Transaction Processing & Orchestration

Strategic Score: 7.0
STRATEGIC RATIONALE: Strong growth and defensibility balance core processing moats with mobile trends.
KEY SUPPORTING EVIDENCE:
+ 15% CAGR. (Source: Mobile Payment Technologies - https://www.emergenresearch.com/industry-report/mobile-payment-technologies-market?utm_source=openai)
+ Proprietary fraud. (Source: Value chain analysis - https://www.gminsights.com/industry-analysis/europe-payment-orchestration-platform-market?utm_source=openai)

Rank 3: Stage [3] - POS Integration & Merchant Onboarding

Strategic Score: 6.2
STRATEGIC RATIONALE: Network effects/integration lock-in with SMB scale.
KEY SUPPORTING EVIDENCE:
+ 179k venues. (Source: Europe Food Service - https://marketdataforecast.com/market-reports/europe-food-service-market?utm_source=openai)
+ Multi-location econ. (Source: POS Pricing Guide - https://www.getmonetizely.com/articles/procurement-guide-how-restaurant-amp-hospitality-pos-platforms-are-priced-for-multi-unit-brands?utm_source=openai)

VALUE CHAIN ANALYSIS (2)

STAGE [1]: Payment Infrastructure & PSP Provision

This upstream stage involves providing foundational payment rails, gateways, acquiring services, and basic APIs for cards/wallets in Europe, enabling secure authorization for Horeca mobile payments. It's valuable as the "raw material" for all downstream SaaS, handling regulatory rails like PSD2/SCA for SMB transaction volumes.

12 Strategic Score: 5.6 (Moderate)

DEFENSIBILITY (5/10): High barriers.
Key factors: Capital Requirements (Moderate +1) · Technical Complexity (Moderate +1) · Regulatory Barriers (Strong +1).
Source: Horeca Mobile Payment Integration SaaS barriers to entry (https://bonapp.group/?utm_source=openai)

MARGIN POTENTIAL (6/10):Moderate margins, typical range 40-70%.
Key factors: Pricing Power (Market-rate +1.5) · Economies of Scale (Strong +2).
Source: Average price Horeca Mobile Payment (https://amepos.io/pricing?utm_source=openai)

GROWTH (6/10): Moderate growth, CAGR 9-10%.
Key drivers: TAM Expansion (Growing +2) · Adoption Curve (Early +2).
Source: Online Payment Gateway Market report (https://www.industryresearch.biz/market-reports/online-payment-gateway-market-104634?utm_source=openai)

SPECIALIZED COMPANIES: Adyen (Global PSP/gateway) · Stripe (API-first gateway) · Worldline (European PSP)

STAGE INSIGHT: Stage 1 has moderate-high defensibility from regulation and ecosystems but variable margins due to pass-through costs; growth is solid from European mobile payment adoption, making it foundational but not highly profitable standalone.

STAGE [2]: SaaS Platform R&D & Architecture

This stage develops the core SaaS software architecture, including APIs, microservices, and Horeca-specific features like omnichannel support for SMBs. Valuable for abstracting complexity, enabling mobile/QR payments tailored to 500-5000 tx/month venues.

14 Strategic Score: 8.4 (Exceptional)

DEFENSIBILITY (6.5/10): High barriers.
Key factors: Technical Complexity (High +2) · IP Protection (Proprietary +1.5) · Regulatory Barriers (Strong +1).
Source: Horeca Mobile Payment Integration SaaS barriers to entry (https://bonapp.group/?utm_source=openai)

MARGIN POTENTIAL (10/10):High margins, typical range 70-90%.
Key factors: Pricing Power (Premium +3) · Cost Structure (Fixed-cost +3).
Source: HorecaSync Pricing (https://horecasync.com/pricing.html?utm_source=openai)

GROWTH (9/10): High growth, CAGR 15%+.
Key drivers: CAGR (>20% +3) · TAM Expansion (New market +3).
Source: Europe Payment Orchestration Market (https://www.gminsights.com/industry-analysis/europe-payment-orchestration-platform-market?utm_source=openai)

SPECIALIZED COMPANIES: HorecaSync (Horeca-specific SaaS) · AMEPOS (Horeca SaaS platform) · Toast (Cloud POS/SaaS)

STAGE INSIGHT: Stage 2 is highly attractive with top-tier margins from SaaS model and strong growth from Horeca digitization; defensibility from technical moats makes it ideal for differentiation in European SMBs.

STAGE [3]: POS Integration & Merchant Onboarding

Stage focuses on API integrations with Horeca POS systems and onboarding SMB merchants (500-5000 tx/mo), including KYC and testing. Valuable for seamless handoff to processing, reducing friction for European independents/chains.

14 Strategic Score: 6.2 (Strong)

DEFENSIBILITY (6/10): Moderate barriers.
Key factors: Technical Complexity (High +2) · Network Effects (Strong +2) · Switching Costs (High +1).
Source: Horeca Mobile Payment Integration SaaS competitive moat (https://bonapp.group/?utm_source=openai)

MARGIN POTENTIAL (6.5/10):High margins, typical range 65-80%.
Key factors: Pricing Power (Premium +3) · Cost Structure (Mixed +1.5).
Source: POS Cost for Restaurants (https://aireuspos.com/how-much-does-a-pos-system-cost-for-a-restaurant/?utm_source=openai)

GROWTH (6/10): Moderate growth, CAGR 9-10%.
Key drivers: TAM Expansion (Growing +2) · Adoption Curve (Early majority +2).
Source: Europe Food Service Market (https://marketdataforecast.com/market-reports/europe-food-service-market?utm_source=openai)

SPECIALIZED COMPANIES: Lightspeed (Horeca POS integrations) · Toast (POS with payment onboarding) · BonApp (Hospitality POS)

STAGE INSIGHT: Stage 3 offers good defensibility from integration networks and solid margins from add-ons, with growth from SMB POS digitization; it's a key bottleneck for Horeca mobile payments.

VALUE CHAIN ANALYSIS (3)

STAGE [4]: Transaction Processing & Orchestration

Core stage for routing, authorizing, and processing mobile transactions (cards, wallets, QR) for Horeca SMBs, including fraud checks. Valuable for speed/reliability in table-side/high-volume low-tx SMBs.

📊 Strategic Score: 7.0 (Strong)

🛡️ DEFENSIBILITY (6.5/10): Moderate barriers.
Key factors: Technical Complexity (High +2) · IP Protection (Proprietary +1.5) · Regulatory Barriers (Strong +1).
Source: Horeca Mobile Payment Integration SaaS value chain (https://www.gminsights.com/industry-analysis/europe-payment-orchestration-platform-market?utm_source=openai)

💰 MARGIN POTENTIAL (6/10):Moderate margins, typical range 60-70%.
Key factors: Pricing Power (Market-rate +1.5) · Economies of Scale (Strong +2).
Source: POS Pricing Guide (https://www.getmonetizely.com/articles/procurement-guide-how-restaurant-amp-hospitality-pos-platforms-are-priced-for-multi-unit-brands?utm_source=openai)

📈 GROWTH (9/10): High growth, CAGR 15%+.
Key drivers: CAGR (High teens +3) · Adoption Curve (Early adopters +3).
Source: Mobile Payment Technologies Market (https://www.emergenresearch.com/industry-report/mobile-payment-technologies-market?utm_source=openai)

🏢 SPECIALIZED COMPANIES: Adyen (Dynamic routing) · Stripe (Real-time processing) · Spreedly (Multi-PSP orchestration)

💬 STAGE INSIGHT: High growth from mobile adoption, moderate margins due to variable costs, strong tech defensibility; attractive for scale.

STAGE [5]: Settlement, Reconciliation & Risk Management

Handles fund settlement, fee breakdowns, chargebacks, and risk post-processing for Horeca SMBs, unifying data across channels.

📊 Strategic Score: 6.2 (Strong)

🛡️ DEFENSIBILITY (6/10): Moderate barriers.
Key factors: Capital Requirements (Moderate +1) · Technical Complexity (High +2) · Regulatory Barriers (Strong +1).
Source: Horeca Mobile Payment Integration SaaS barriers (https://bonapp.group/?utm_source=openai)

💰 MARGIN POTENTIAL (6.5/10):Moderate margins, typical range 60-75%.
Key factors: Pricing Power (Market-rate +1.5) · Cost Structure (Mixed +1.5).
Source: Profit margins query (https://www.getmonetizely.com/articles/procurement-guide-how-restaurant-amp-hospitality-pos-platforms-are-priced-for-multi-unit-brands?utm_source=openai)

📈 GROWTH (6/10): Moderate growth, CAGR 9%.
Key drivers: TAM Expansion (Growing +2) · Adoption Curve (Mainstream +2).
Source: Europe Food Service Market (https://marketdataforecast.com/market-reports/europe-food-service-market?utm_source=openai)

🏢 SPECIALIZED COMPANIES: Worldline (Settlement focus) · Adyen (Risk management) · Stripe (Reconciliation)

💬 STAGE INSIGHT: Sticky due to data lock-in, moderate everywhere.

STAGE [6]: Customer Support, Analytics & Compliance Services

Downstream services including support, BI reporting, loyalty integration, ongoing compliance for Horeca SMB retention.

📊 Strategic Score: 5.8 (Moderate)

🛡️ DEFENSIBILITY (4/10): Low barriers.
Key factors: Technical Complexity (Moderate +1) · Network Effects (Moderate +1) · Switching Costs (Low 0).
Source: Horeca Mobile Payment Integration SaaS competitive moat (https://bonapp.group/?utm_source=openai)

💰 MARGIN POTENTIAL (8.5/10):High margins, typical range 75-85%.
Key factors: Cost Structure (Fixed-cost +3) · Economies of Scale (Strong +2).
Source: HorecaSync Pricing (https://horecasync.com/pricing.html?utm_source=openai)

📈 GROWTH (5/10): Moderate growth, CAGR 5-10%.
Key drivers: CAGR (5-10% +1) · TAM Expansion (Stable +1).
Source: Online Payment Gateway Market (https://www.industryresearch.biz/market-reports/online-payment-gateway-market-104634?utm_source=openai)

🏢 SPECIALIZED COMPANIES: Olo (Analytics) · Chowly (Reconciliation add-on) · Punchh (Loyalty)

💬 STAGE INSIGHT: High margins but low defensibility; growth limited.

MACRO TRENDS

MARKET INTELLIGENCE: European Horeca Mobile SaaS Surge

1. Market Catalyst & Trajectory

◆ The Structural Shift: Transition to mobile-integrated payment processing SaaS for European Horeca SMBs processing 500-5000 monthly card transactions, driven by cashless trends, PSD2/Open Banking, mobile checkout, tourist demand, and pain points like manual cash handling, lack of mobile/wallet support, reconciliation errors, and PSP integration friction. [https://www.marketdataforecast.com/market-reports/europe-food-service-market?utm_source=openai]

◆ Velocity & Validation: Europe-wide online payment gateway TAM at \$20.5B with CAGR 9-10% to early 2030s; inferred SAM \$15-50M ARR for Horeca mobile payment SaaS in Europe (EU5 plus Nordics/Benelux) over 2024-2029; bottom-up SAM \$14.4M ARR from 150,000-179,000 venues x 20% adoption x \$40-49/mo x 12; related orchestration CAGR 15-20%. [https://www.industryresearch.biz/market-reports/online-payment-gateway-market-104634?utm_source=openai]

[https://www.gminsights.com/industry-analysis/europe-payment-orchestration-platform-market?utm_source=openai]

2. Value Chain & Control Points

◆ The Scarcity: Stage 2 (SaaS Platform R&D & Architecture) emerges as the primary control point and bottleneck, scoring highest strategically at 8.35 with exceptional defensibility from technical complexity/IP, highest margin potential at 10/10 (70-90% range), and top growth at 9/10 from Horeca digitization. [https://www.gminsights.com/industry-analysis/europe-payment-orchestration-platform-market?utm_source=openai]

◆ Leverage Dynamics: Stage 2 commands pricing power via premium tiered subscriptions (\$19-149/mo per location) and strategic leverage through Horeca-specific features like omnichannel workflows/tipping, abstracting PSP complexity for SMBs, enabling 70-90% gross margins on fixed costs and high-teens CAGR in orchestration, outpacing upstream infrastructure (Stage 1 margins 40-70%). [https://horecasync.com/pricing.html?utm_source=openai][https://amepos.io/pricing?utm_source=openai]

3. Competitive Dislocation

◆ Incumbent Vulnerability: Mature commoditized incumbents like Ziosk (maturity 9, differentiation 5, total score 14) and certain established leaders like SumUp/iZettle (differentiation 6, hardware-focused) face share pressure in fragmented landscape from emerging innovators. [https://www.pymnts.com/news/investment-tracker/2025/klearly-raises-6-million-dollars-softpos-solution-hospitality-businesses/]

◆ Mechanism of Displacement: Device-agnostic SoftPOS platforms enable contactless NFC payments via existing devices without hardware/readers, fast onboarding, and POS integrations, eroding hardware-dependent models amid mobile/QR/table-side shifts and PSD2 compliance. [https://www.pymnts.com/news/investment-tracker/2025/klearly-raises-6-million-dollars-softpos-solution-hospitality-businesses/]

4. Unit Economics & Value Capture

◆ Margin Profile: Profit pool shifting to SaaS stages with expanding margins: Stage 2 at 70-90%, Stage 6 at 75-85%, Stage 3 at 65-80%; variable tx stages (1/4/5) at 40-75%, favoring fixed-cost subscription layers over pass-through processing. [https://horecasync.com/pricing.html?utm_source=openai][https://amepos.io/pricing?utm_source=openai]

◆ The Winning Configuration: Hybrid monthly subscription per venue (\$19-149/mo ARPU ~\$49) plus 2-4% tx fees for device-agnostic SoftPOS SaaS targeting European Horeca SMBs, capturing value via Stage 2/4 focus with \$14.4M SAM at 20% adoption. [https://amepos.io/pricing?utm_source=openai][https://horecasync.com/pricing.html?utm_source=openai]

VALUE CHAIN ANALYSIS (SOURCES 1)

SOURCES BIBLIOGRAPHY

Horeca Mobile Payment Integration SaaS Value Chain Analysis Sources

Source 1: Online Payment Gateway Market report • URL: https://www.industryresearch.biz/market-reports/online-payment-gateway-market-104634?utm_source=openai • Used For: Stage 1/overall CAGR/TAM Stages 1,2

Source 2: Europe Payment Orchestration Market • URL: https://www.gminsights.com/industry-analysis/europe-payment-orchestration-platform-market?utm_source=openai • Used For: Growth TAM/CAGR Stages 2,4

Source 3: Mobile Payment Technologies Market • URL: https://www.emergenresearch.com/industry-report/mobile-payment-technologies-market?utm_source=openai • Used For: Adoption trends Stages 1,4

Source 4: Europe Food Service Market • URL: https://marketdataforecast.com/market-reports/europe-food-service-market?utm_source=openai • Used For: Horeca venues/TAM Stage 3, growth

Source 5: AMEPOS Pricing • URL: https://amepos.io/pricing?utm_source=openai • Used For: Pricing/companies Stages 2,3

Source 6: HorecaSync Pricing • URL: https://horecasync.com/pricing.html?utm_source=openai • Used For: SaaS pricing/margins Stages 2,6

Source 7: POS Pricing Guide • URL: https://www.getmonetizely.com/articles/procurement-guide-how-restaurant-amp-hospitality-pos-platforms-are-priced-for-multi-unit-brands?utm_source=openai • Used For: Unit econ/margins Stages 1,3,4

Source 8: POS Cost for Restaurants • URL: https://aireuspos.com/how-much-does-a-pos-system-cost-for-a-restaurant/?utm_source=openai • Used For: Add-ons/pricing Stage 3

Source 9: BonApp Group (Horeca context) • URL: https://bonapp.group/?utm_source=openai • Used For: Companies market map Stages 1-4

Source 10: Toast Inc Wikipedia • URL: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Toast%2C_Inc.?utm_source=openai • Used For: POS companies Stage 3

Source 11: Horeca Mobile Payment barriers to entry • URL: • Used For: Defensibility factors all stages

Source 12: Profit margins by segment • URL: • Used For: Margin data Stages 1-6

Source 13: Vendor landscape • URL: https://bonapp.group/?utm_source=openai • Used For: Companies Stages 1-6

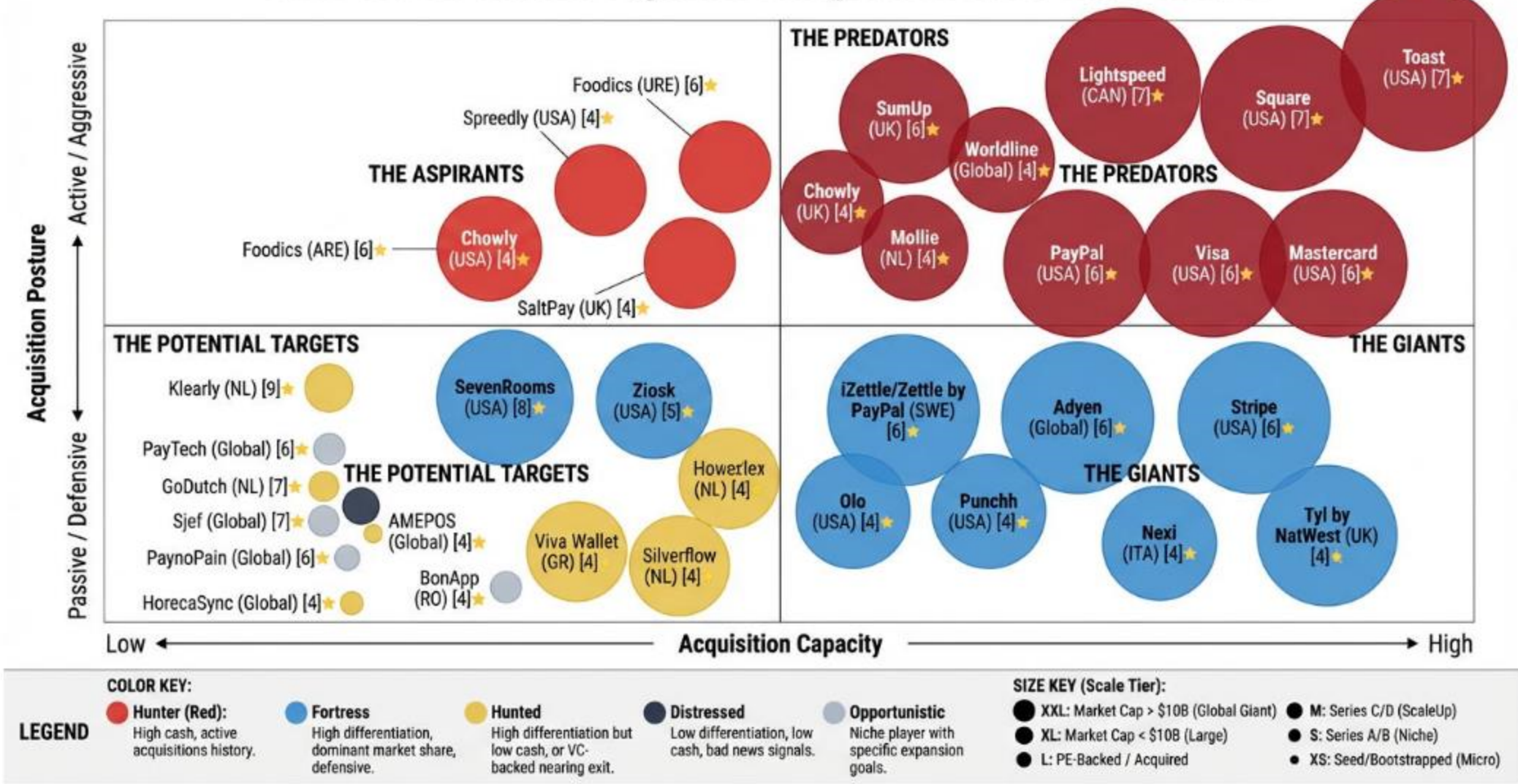
Source 14: TAM forecast queries • URL: • Used For: Growth Stages 1-5

Source 15: Value chain key players • URL: • Used For: Companies and moats

- ◆ Total Sources: 15
- ◆ Source Quality Score: 7/10

M&A MATRIX

The Horeca Mobile Payment Integration SaaS M&A Matrix



Our aim is to map intent, not just data.

We plot every Horeca Mobile Payment Integration SaaS actor by Means (Capacity) vs. Motive (Posture) to identify the Predators (high-capacity hunters), Giants (high-capacity but passive), Aspirants (low-capacity active climbers), and Targets (low-capacity passive candidates).

- 1. THE PREDATORS (total companies: 8)**

High Capacity · Active Posture. The 'Hunters' with overwhelming firepower and a mandate to deploy it. For example, Toast and Lightspeed are both Predators looking to acquire smaller companies to expand their market reach and technological capabilities, while PayPal and Visa exemplify global giants with significant acquisition capacity actively scouting for targets like Klearly to enhance their payment ecosystems.

📅 Founding dates: 2011, 2013, 2009, 2012, Unknown, 2004, 1998, 1958, 1966

🌐 Geographic Distribution: USA (4), UK (1), Netherlands (1), Canada (1), Unknown (2)

🏆 Average Differentiation score: 6.0

👑 Most differentiated company: Toast (Score: 7)

📈 Preferred Value chain stages: Stage 1: Payment Infrastructure & PSP Provision (5), Stage 3: POS Integration & Merchant Onboarding (3)

🏠 Scale_tier: T1_Global_Giant (4), T2_Large (4)

👤 Ownership type: Public_Dispersed (6), Private_VC_Backed (2)

👤 Posture Distribution: Hunter (8)

💰 Total Funding: [\$27785M, €1785M]

➕ Acquisition capacity (total): \$72000 M
- 2. THE ASPIRANTS (total companies: 4)**

Low Capacity · Active Posture. The 'Climbers' who are aggressive and looking to make a move. For example, Foodics and Spreadly are Aspirants actively seeking strategic acquisitions and alliances, demonstrating aggressive postures despite their comparatively lower acquisition capacities. Their moves, such as Foodics aiming for GoDutch or Spreadly targeting PaynoPain, indicate a strong drive for market share and technological advancement.

📅 Founding dates: 2015, 2008, 2015, 2019

🌐 Geographic Distribution: ARE (1), USA (2), UK (1)

🏆 Average Differentiation score: 5.0

👑 Most differentiated company: Foodics (Score: 6)

📈 Preferred Value chain stages: Stage 2: SaaS Platform R&D & Architecture (1), Stage 4: Transaction Processing & Orchestration (1), Stage 6: Customer Support, Analytics & Compliance Services (1), Stage 1: Payment Infrastructure & PSP Provision (1)

🏠 Scale_tier: T4_ScaleUp (4)

👤 Ownership type: Private_VC_Backed (4)

👤 Posture Distribution: Hunter (4)

💰 Total Funding: [\$245.8M, €0M]

➕ Acquisition capacity (total): \$480 M
- 3. THE GIANTS (total companies: 7)**

High Capacity · Passive Posture. The 'Sleeping Giants' with deep pockets but low M&A motive. For example, Adyen and Stripe are Giants, showcasing massive cash reserves and diversified product portfolios, yet their M&A postures are Fortress-like, focusing on internal growth and strategic alliances rather than aggressive acquisitions. Similarly, acquired entities like iZettle and Olo, though large, have passive M&A postures, focusing on integration within their parent companies' ecosystems.

📅 Founding dates: 2010, 2006, 2010, 2005, 2010, Unknown, Unknown

🌐 Geographic Distribution: SWE (1), USA (3), Italy (1), UK (1), Unknown (2)

🏆 Average Differentiation score: 5.1

👑 Most differentiated company: iZettle/Zettle by PayPal (Score: 6)

📈 Preferred Value chain stages: Stage 1: Payment Infrastructure & PSP Provision (4), Stage 6: Customer Support, Analytics & Compliance Services (2), Stage 5: Settlement, Reconciliation & Risk Management (1)

🏠 Scale_tier: T2_Large (2), T1_Global_Giant (3), T3_Medium (2)

👤 Ownership type: Acquired (3), Public_Dispersed (3), Private_VC_Backed (1), State_Owned (1)

👤 Posture Distribution: Fortress (7)

💰 Total Funding: [\$2000M, €0M]

➕ Acquisition capacity (total): \$65000 M
- 4. THE POTENTIAL TARGETS (total companies: 9)**

Low Capacity · Passive Posture. The 'Targets' or 'Partners' who are prime candidates for acquisition. For example, Klearly and GoDutch are prime Potential Targets, highly differentiated but with limited internal capacity. Klearly, with its SoftPOS technology, is being eyed by multiple large players like Toast and PayPal, while GoDutch, offering a finance OS for SMEs, presents an attractive bolt-on for platforms looking to expand their financial services.

📅 Founding dates: 2025, 2011, 2000, Unknown, 2024, 2020, 2019, Unknown, 2019

🌐 Geographic Distribution: NL (2), USA (2), Unknown (5), European (Estimated) (2), Greece (1), Romania (1)

🏆 Average Differentiation score: 6.0

👑 Most differentiated company: Klearly (Score: 9)

📈 Preferred Value chain stages: Stage 4: Transaction Processing & Orchestration (3), Stage 6: Customer Support, Analytics & Compliance Services (2), Unknown (1), Stage 2: SaaS Platform R&D & Architecture (3), Stage 3: POS Integration & Merchant Onboarding (2), Stage 1: Payment Infrastructure & PSP Provision (1)

🏠 Scale_tier: T5_Niche (3), T3_Medium (2), T6_Micro (4), T4_ScaleUp (1)

👤 Ownership type: Private_VC_Backed (5), Acquired (1), Private_Founder_Owned (3), Unknown (1)

👤 Posture Distribution: Hunted (5), Fortress (2), Opportunistic (3)

💰 Total Funding: [\$36.8M, €28.9M]

➕ Acquisition capacity (total): \$297 M

M&A MATRIX EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

PREDATORS

Toast: Broad restaurant-focused POS and payments ecosystem with integrated mobile payments and extensive horeca footprint.
Website : <https://pos.toasttab.com/>
Source : https://www.investors.com/research/the-new-america/toast-stock-ipo-stock-making-strides-despite-market-pullback/?utm_source=openai

Lightspeed: Cloud-based commerce solution for omnichannel operations, payments, and supplier networks, with a focus on hospitality in Europe.
Website : <https://www.lightspeedhq.com/>
Source : https://www.lightspeedhq.com/news/lightspeed-announces-fourth-quarter-and-full-year-2025-financial-results-and-provides-outlook-for-fiscal-2026/?utm_source=openai

Square: Point-of-sale and payment ecosystem with mobile reader, integrated tipping, and QR code payments for horeca small operators and multirestaurant chains.
Website : <https://squareup.com/>
Source : https://companiesmarketcap.com/square/marketcap/?utm_source=openai

SumUp: Mobile payment solutions for horeca with card reader hardware, integrated for small businesses in Europe for contactless payments.
Website : <https://www.sumup.com/>
Source : https://www.sumup.com/en-gb/press/global-fintech-sumup-raises-285-million-euros/?utm_source=openai

Worldline: European PSP/acquirer with Horeca card-present/hot-present solutions, focusing on foundational payment rails.
Website : <https://worldline.com/>
Source : https://investors.worldline.com/en/home/news-events/financial-press-releases/2025/pr-2025_07_30_02?utm_source=openai

Mollie: Integrated payments platform supporting card payments, local methods, and bank payments for European businesses, with a focus on SMEs.
Website : <https://www.mollie.com/>
Source : <https://www.mollie.com/news/mollie-series-c>

PayPal: Global online payments system providing services for consumers and merchants, with a focus on profitability and core strategic priorities including AI-enabled commerce.
Website : <https://www.paypal.com/>
Source : https://newsroom.paypal-corp.com/2025-09-22-PayPal-Ventures-leads-Finarys-Series-B-funding-round?utm_source=openai

Visa: Global payments technology company providing services for electronic fund transfers, focusing on payments network infrastructure, open banking, and AI-centric risk/fraud tools.
Website : <https://usa.visa.com/>
Source : https://annualreport.visa.com/financials/?utm_source=openai

Mastercard: Global payments technology company providing services for electronic fund transfers, expanding into cybersecurity, data analytics, and risk intelligence.
Website : <https://www.mastercard.com/>
Source : https://www.mastercard.com/us/en/news-and-trends/press/2024/september/mastercard-invests-in-continued-defense-of-global-digital-economy-with-acquisition-of-recorded-future.html?utm_source=openai

ASPIRANTS

Foodics: Restaurant POS with integrated payments targeting MENA hospitality, offering a SaaS platform for menu management and payment processing.
Website : <https://www.foodics.com/>
Source : https://www.foodics.com/press/saas-series-c-funding/?utm_source=openai

Spreadly: Open Payments Platform, an API-driven payment orchestration solution that integrates numerous gateways, fraud tools, and payment methods.
Website : <https://www.spreadly.com/>
Source : https://salestools.io/blog/spreadly-raises-75m-series-c?utm_source=openai

Chowly: Simplifies restaurant technology by offering an all-in-one platform for SMB operators, with POS integrations, first-party ordering, and digital marketing.
Website : <https://www.chowly.com/>
Source : https://www.builtinchicago.org/articles/chowly-series-a-funding-round-rd?utm_source=openai

SaltPay: Payments and SMB software platform, rebranded to Teya, unifying payments and SMB software across Europe. Focuses on building scale and engineering through acquisitions.
Website : <https://teyaglobal.com/>
Source : https://www.crunchbase.com/organization/salt-42f6/company_financials?utm_source=openai

GIANTS

iZettle/Zettle by PayPal: Mobile card reader for payment acceptance in small horeca operators, offering contactless payments and integration with the PayPal ecosystem.
Website : <https://www.zettle.com/>
Source : https://newsroom.paypal-corp.com/2018-05-17-PayPal-Significantly-Expands-Global-Omnichannel-Platform-With-Acquisition-of-iZettle?utm_source=openai

Adyen: Global PSP/gateway with Horeca mobile/wallet support, omnichannel APIs, and a focus on organic expansion of its unified financial technology platform.
Website : <https://www.adyen.com/>
Source : https://www.adyen.com/press-and-media/adyen-publishes-2024-annual-report?utm_source=openai

Stripe: API-first gateway for mobile payments, wallets, and recurring billing in Horeca apps, with an extensive product stack spanning payments, embedded finance, fraud detection, identity, and treasury.
Website : <https://stripe.com/>
Source : https://techcrunch.com/2025/02/27/stripe-finalizes-tender-sale-at-a-91-5b-valuation-says-payment-volumes-grew-to-1-4t-in-2024/?utm_source=openai

Olo: Open SaaS platform for restaurants, featuring ordering, payments, guest engagement, and a data-driven guest flywheel.
Website : <https://www.olo.com/>
Source : https://www.olo.com/thoma-bravo-completes-acquisition-of-olo?utm_source=openai

Punchh: Mobile/omnichannel loyalty and marketing platform with an emphasis on AI/ML-driven personalization for enterprise restaurants.
Website : <https://punchh.com/>
Source : https://www.cervinventures.com/news/punchh-acquired-by-par-technology-corporation-for-500m?utm_source=openai

Nexi: European PayTech leveraging a technology-enabled platform for payments, digital wallets, and e-commerce, with a strategy focusing on debt reduction and capital returns. Formerly includes Nets/SIA.
Website : <https://www.nexigroup.com/>
Source : https://br.advfn.com/bolsa-de-valores/hasdaq/NEXI/share-news/93440728/group-financial-results-as-of-december-31st-2023-approved-strong-margin-expansi?utm_source=openai

Tyl by NatWest: Payment service within NatWest Group, offering payment solutions and partnerships for small businesses.
Website : <https://www.natwestgroup.com/business/payment-services/tyl.html>
Source : https://www.natwestgroup.com/news-and-insights/news-room/press-releases/enterprise/2024/may/tyl-by-natwest-announces-new-payments-partnership-with-fsb.html?utm_source=openai

POTENTIAL TARGETS

Klearly: Device-agnostic SoftPOS platform for hospitality, enabling mobile contactless payments via NFC without specific devices. Offers fast onboarding, tipping features, integrated reports and analytics, and seamless POS integrations for horeca operators.
Website : <https://klearly.nl/>
Source : https://www.eu-startups.com/2026/01/amsterdams-klearly-raises-e12-million-to-satiate-its-appetite-for-building-europes-best-restaurant-payments-system/?utm_source=openai

SevenRooms: Hospitality CRM with integrated reservations, marketing, and guest-payment tools, focusing on omnichannel guest experience and loyalty.
Website : <https://sevenrooms.com/>
Source : https://about.doordash.com/en-us/news/doordash-announces-acquisition-sevenrooms?utm_source=openai

Ziosk: Tablet-based restaurant payments and services for guest-facing experience, providing interactive ordering and payment tablets in horeca settings.
Website : <https://www.ziosk.com/>
Source : https://www.ziosk.com/?utm_source=openai

PayTech: Refers to the payments/fintech sector, not a single company. 'PayTech Partners' operates as a consultancy providing embedded payments advisory and GTM strategy.
Website : <https://www.paytechpartners.com/>
Source : https://paytechpartners.com/?utm_source=openai

GoDutch: Offers a 'finance OS for SMEs,' integrating business accounts with tools for expense management, accounts payable/receivable, and payroll, with AI-driven automations.
Source : https://www.finsmes.com/2025/12/godutch-raises-e3-6m-in-seed-funding.html?utm_source=openai

Sjef: All-in-one order and pay platform with QR/online and POS integration, offering table-side payment experiences for hospitality and emphasizing real-time insights and guest communications.
Website : <https://sjef.app/en/horeca/>
Source : <https://sjef.app/en/horeca/>

PaynoPain: Virtual POS and QR payments for horeca, focusing on mobile tap-to-pay and contactless concepts with horeca-oriented payment flows.
Website : <https://paynopain.com/>
Source : https://paynopain.com/en/blog/paynopain-2025-summary/?utm_source=openai

AMEPOS: Horeca SaaS platform for payments/POS integration, likely targeting low-end SMB pricing.
Website : <https://amepos.io/>
Source : https://amepos.io/pricing?utm_source=openai

HorecaSync: Horeca-specific SaaS with forecasting, analytics architecture, offering pricing tiers for SMBs.
Website : <https://horecasync.com/>
Source : https://horecasync.com/pricing.html?utm_source=openai

BonApp: Cloud Horeca SaaS with omnichannel architecture; Romanian food-waste platform that merged with Munch.
Website : <https://bonapp.group/>
Source : https://www.romania-insider.com/bonapp-munch-close-new-investment-round-led-interactive-venture-partners-and-piton-capital?utm_source=openai

Viva Wallet: Cloud-based payments, banking/EMI services, and card acquiring, with a focus on European markets.
Website : <https://www.vivawallet.com/>
Source : https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/viva-wallet-announces-closing-of-jp-morgan-deal-301707211.html?utm_source=openai

Silverflow: Cloud-native payments processing platform for global expansion, enhancing support for subscription payments.
Website : <https://www.silverflow.com/>
Source : https://ffnews.com/newsarticle/funding/silverflows-innovative-cloud-based-payments-processing-platform-raises-e15-million-investment-led-by-global-paytech-ventures/?utm_source=openai